



Project Management and Sales

Teacher
Renan Grossi
(51) 98135 3067

Clarifying Roles and Responsibilities

In the world of project management and sales, clear communication and well-defined roles are essential for success. This becomes especially important when working on tight deadlines and managing high-stakes clients. The ability to express what you **can** do, what you **could** do in the future, and what you might **be able to** achieve with the right conditions is vital in these fields. At the same time, knowing whether to **do** or **make** something can impact how tasks and responsibilities are described, ensuring the team remains aligned.

Emma, a seasoned project manager, is currently overseeing a project to develop a new e-commerce platform for a major retail client. Her role involves coordinating with various departments, from sales and development to design and quality assurance. Mark, the sales manager, serves as the primary point of contact with the client and often negotiates timelines and deliverables.

At the start of the week, Emma called a meeting with Mark to discuss the project's progress and address potential roadblocks.

The Conversation:

Emma: Mark, thanks for joining. I wanted to check in about the client's latest feedback. Do you think you **can** reach out to clarify their priorities? Right now, there's some

confusion about which features are non-negotiable.

35 Mark: Absolutely, I **can** handle that. In fact, I think I'll be **able to** get them to specify their top three requirements. I've already built a good rapport with their product team.

40 Emma: That's great to hear. If you **could** confirm those priorities by Wednesday, it would help us finalize the design phase. The team is hesitant to move forward without a clearer scope.

45 Mark: Understood. By the way, did the team **make** any updates to the initial wireframes?

50 Emma: They've started working on it, but there's a lot more to **do**. The designers are focusing on the homepage layout, but they'll need your input before we move on to other sections.

Mark: Sure thing. I'll review the wireframes once they're ready. Also, the client asked if we **could** deliver a prototype earlier than
55 planned. Do you think we'd be **able to** accommodate that request?

Emma: That depends on the scope. If they're open to a simplified version for the prototype, we **can** aim for an earlier delivery. But
60 if they expect all features to be included, we'd need more time.

Mark: Got it. I'll propose the simplified version and see if they agree. It's always a balancing act to **make** clients happy without
65 overpromising.

Emma: Exactly. And speaking of balance, I wanted to check on the sales report you were preparing for the executive team. Were you able to **make** the updates we discussed last week?

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Mark: Yes, I've started incorporating your suggestions. There's still some analysis to **do**, but I'll have it ready by Friday.

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Emma: Perfect. Once that's done, we'll **make** sure the report highlights the client's strategic value. It'll help us justify any additional resources we might request.

Mark: Agreed. Let me know if there's anything else I can support you with.

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Emma: Will do. Thanks, Mark. Let's regroup after your call with the client.

Reflection:

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This conversation highlights the dynamic nature of collaboration in project management and sales. Emma's role as a project manager requires her to ensure that tasks are clearly defined and that the team can meet deadlines without compromising quality.

Meanwhile, Mark's role in sales involves negotiation, relationship-building, and ensuring
90 the client's needs are aligned with the team's capacity.

By effectively managing their respective responsibilities, Emma and Mark ensure the project stays on track while maintaining strong
95 client relationships.